

BPRO Final Project Proposal

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For our final project, we want to make a new version of the Golden Record. The original Golden Record is a phonograph (vinyl) record, containing sounds and images chosen to portray life and culture on Earth, sent into space—like a message in a glass bottle—for intelligent extraterrestrial life to find and interpret. The records are a time capsule of important scientific and cultural artefacts selected by a team led by Carl Sagan and sent aboard the two Voyager spacecrafts in 1977. It has been almost 50 years since then, and much has changed culturally and scientifically. In our new Golden Record, we propose to encapsulate information including the following:

- How to read this record
- Mathematics & physics constants
- Chemistry & DNA
- Earth system time-lapse
- Tree of life & humans
- Voices, sounds, music
- Tools, cities, networks
- Knowledge plates & open questions
- Ethics & stories
- Star map & reply instructions

(Compilation of data and media, but also original work).

We propose to encode this data as physical media, e.g., a CD, SD card, or vinyl.

Additionally, we will attempt to encode a “looper” MIDI keyboard (Rhea owns one) that can serve as a live demo (or demonstrated through video). Each pad/noise on the looper will represent either a variable in the Drake equation or an element involved in the “recipe of life” as discussed in class; whether that is temperature, distance, or something else, we will choose pitches or rhythms that feel appropriate for each element/variable. If the MIDI keyboard is unprogrammable in this way, we will develop a web application that does something similar through Python and JavaScript (or Svelte).